

CERT-In · MeitY · Government of India

An Initiative of CERT-In under the aegis of MeitY

HASHTAG SURAKSHA

India's First National Cybersecurity Movement

A government-backed ecosystem dedicated to making every Indian student, teacher, and community cyber-safe, digitally literate, and future-ready.

CASK

Surakshak

Olympiad

Phish & Chip

Slanglish



THE MOVEMENT

India Has a Cyber Problem.

And a national movement to solve it.

India is the world's fastest-growing digital economy. With hundreds of millions of first-time internet users — most of them students — coming online every year, the gap between digital access and digital safety has never been wider. Cybercrime is rising. Scams, identity theft, sextortion, and misinformation are targeting young people who were never taught to recognise them.

Hashtag Suraksha is India's answer. A national cybersecurity movement — government-backed, school-embedded, student-led — built to reach every student, teacher, and community across 28 states. Not a programme. A movement.

"Cybersecurity is no longer a matter of choice in the current era of rapid digital transformation."

— Dr. Sanjay Bahl, Director General, CERT-In

WHAT IS HASHTAG SURAKSHA?

Hashtag Suraksha is a joint initiative of **CERT-In** — India's national cybersecurity agency under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) — and **Cyber Buddha**, India's technology-first cyber safety organisation. Together, they have built a five-vertical ecosystem that embeds digital safety into India's schools through intelligent learning, national competition, student leadership, and culturally rooted digital literacy.

The ecosystem is NEP 2020-aligned, free for schools to join, and designed for real-world impact — not just awareness.

FIVE VERTICALS. ONE MISSION.

1	CASK	AI-Powered Cyber Safety Learning Platform for schools
2	Surakshak	Student Ambassador Program — peer-led safety movement
3	National Cyber Olympiad	National competition across Quiz and Reel tracks
4	The Phish & Chip Show	India's first Gen-Z cybersecurity podcast
5	Slanglish	Digital literacy through internet language and culture

VERTICAL 01 · AI LEARNING PLATFORM

CASK

Cyber Abhyas Sakriya Kshamta

CASK is India's first AI-powered cyber safety learning platform — built in collaboration with CERT-In, MeitY, Cyber Buddha, and Summer Art of Living. It delivers structured cyber safety education through free learning resources and an intelligent AI tutor called **Suraksha AI**.

CASK is NEP 2020-aligned, free for all schools to access, and designed for students in Classes 6 to 12, their teachers, and school leadership. It is the academic backbone of the Hashtag Suraksha ecosystem.

WHAT CASK DELIVERS

1

CASK FEATURE

AI Tutor — Suraksha AI

An intelligent conversational AI that teaches cyber safety by answering student questions, guiding exploration, and adapting to learning pace.

2

CASK FEATURE

9 Structured Learning Modules

Covering phishing & scams, password safety, social media risks, AI & deepfakes, cyber law, digital citizenship, privacy, online identity, and misinformation.

3

CASK FEATURE

Free Learning Resources

Ready-made lesson plans, video tutorials, mind maps, and quizzes — all structured for seamless classroom delivery with zero teacher preparation.

4

CASK FEATURE

School Dashboard

Track every student's progress in real time. Identify gaps, monitor engagement, and share results with parents — fully automated.

WHO CASK IS FOR

Students Classes 6–12

Teachers All subjects, all
boards

Schools Nationwide, free to
join

VERTICAL 02 · AMBASSADOR PROGRAM

Surakshak

India's Student Cyber Safety Ambassador Network

Details of the Surakshak program will be shared separately.

VERTICAL 03 · NATIONAL COMPETITION

National Cyber Olympiad

India's biggest cybersecurity competition — school to national level

The National Cyber Olympiad is India's largest student cybersecurity competition, backed by CERT-In and hosted on MyGov. It challenges students across three age categories to test their cyber awareness, practical detection skills, and conceptual understanding — progressing from school level to national finals.

THREE CATEGORIES

Classes 6–8

Junior Category

Classes 9–10

Intermediate Category

Classes 11–12

Senior Category

THREE LEVELS OF COMPETITION

LEVEL 1

Cyber Awareness Test

A structured assessment testing foundational knowledge of cyber safety.

Topics: cyber hygiene, digital rights, online threats, and safe practices.

Format: Quiz-based. Conducted at the school level.

LEVEL 2

Detection Challenge

Students analyse real-world scenarios involving phishing messages, malicious message logs, suspicious links, and social engineering attempts.

Format: Applied scenario-based. State-level competition.

LEVEL 3

Conceptual Explanation & Detection

The highest level of the Olympiad. Students demonstrate both the ability to detect threats and to explain the underlying concepts behind them.

Format: Comprehensive. National finals.

THE JOURNEY



Winners receive national recognition, CERT-In certificates, prizes, and a place in the Hall of Fame. The competition runs across Quiz and Reel tracks, making it accessible to students of every skill type.

VERTICAL 04 · PODCAST SERIES

The Phish & Chip Show

India's first Gen-Z cybersecurity podcast — story-first, expert-led

The Phish & Chip Show is a cybersecurity podcast built for young India — told through real stories, not lectures. A Gen-Z host and a cybersecurity expert unpick the threats that actually affect young people's lives: scams, fake profiles, sextortion, romance fraud, misinformation, digital reputation, and more.

Every episode follows a disciplined story-first format — each cybersecurity concept is introduced through a verified, sourced real-world case before the teaching begins. The result is content that genuinely holds attention and genuinely changes behaviour.

THE SHOW FORMAT

11 Segments per episode · Story-First Format · Verified real-world cases

Each segment: Cybersecurity Concept → Real Story → Teaching Breakdown

Sign-off: "Stay curious, stay cautious — and don't fall for the phish."

EPISODE STRUCTURE — SEGMENT BY SEGMENT

1

Digital Footprints & What Your Posts Reveal

Passive data exposure · OSINT · the aggregation problem

2

Privacy Settings Deep-Dive

Attack surface reduction · platform default settings

3

Fake Profiles & Impersonation

Identity spoofing · synthetic personas · social engineering

4

Sextortion & Intimate Image Abuse

AI-generated deepfakes · image morphing · reporting protocols

5

Cyberbullying & Pile-Ons

Coordinated harassment · anonymity as enabler · platform accountability

6

Account Takeover & Recovery

Phishing · credential harvesting · the 30-minute recovery window

7

Link Traps in DMs

Task-based scams · fake job offers · 2FA as last line of defence

8

The Follower Economy Scams

Trust exploitation · influencer-targeted scams · fake brand deals

9

Misinformation & Viral Hoaxes

Information manipulation · user-as-vector · 60-second fact-check method

10

Dating Apps & Romance Scams

Catfishing · long-term social engineering · sextortion via trust escalation

11

Digital Reputation & Permanence

Digital permanence · reputational persistence · online identity management

THE PHISH OR CHIP? ROUND

Every episode features a rapid-fire myth-busting segment called **Phish or Chip?** — where the host calls out a common cyber belief as either a **Phish** (a dangerous myth) or a **Chip** (a verified fact). These 30-second standalone clips are the show's virality engine — built to live independently on Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts.

SPOT IT · STOP IT · SHARE IT

Every teaching segment closes with three actionable lines — **SPOT IT** (how to recognise the threat), **STOP IT** (what to do immediately), and **SHARE IT** (what to pass on to your network). This three-part close is the show's signature framework for turning awareness into action.

VERTICAL 05 · DIGITAL LITERACY

Slanglish

Decode the internet. Navigate culture. Stay safe.

Slanglish is Hashtag Suraksha's digital literacy vertical — built on a simple insight: young people live in internet culture before they understand it. The language of online spaces — Gen-Z slang, platform terminology, social media vocabulary — is also the language of manipulation, grooming, and online risk.

Slanglish closes that gap. It decodes internet slang, online culture, and cyber terminology through quizzes, interactive games, and vocabulary challenges — making digital literacy engaging, culturally relevant, and genuinely accessible to everyone, regardless of age or technical background.

HOW SLANGLISH WORKS

1

SLANGLISH FEATURE

Vocabulary Challenges

Each term is presented with its everyday meaning, its cyber safety implication, and a practical tip for staying safe when encountering it online.

2

SLANGLISH FEATURE

Interactive Quizzes & Games

Gamified formats that make digital literacy genuinely engaging — not a lecture. Designed for students but accessible to parents, teachers, and communities.

3

SLANGLISH FEATURE

Dual-Layer Learning

Every word teaches two things: what it means in internet culture, and how it connects to real online risks and manipulation tactics.

THE SLANGLISH LEXICON — A SAMPLE

Rizz	Ghosted	Catfish	Simp
Finsta	Ragebait	FOMO	Stan
Deepfake	Ratio	Clout	Brainrot
Vibe Check	No Cap	Lowkey	Slay

Each term carries a cyber safety lesson hidden inside everyday language — making Slanglish the vertical that meets young people where they already are.

THE BACKING

Partners & Institutions

Government. Technology. Education. Community.

OFFICIAL GOVERNMENT PARTNER

CERT-In · Indian Computer Emergency Response Team

The national cybersecurity agency of India under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). India's authority for cyber incident response under the IT Act 2000. CERT-In co-develops, endorses, and amplifies every vertical of the Hashtag Suraksha ecosystem.

TECHNOLOGY & EDUCATION PARTNER

Cyber Buddha · Technology-First Cyber Safety Organisation

Develops the CASK platform, Surakshak program infrastructure, and all digital learning resources within the ecosystem. Published government-commissioned books on cyber safety — including an Amazon bestseller and Asian Literary Award winner.

PRINCIPAL INDUSTRY PARTNER

USI · Principal Partner

Hashtag Suraksha's principal industry partner — supporting national reach, institutional credibility, and on-ground amplification of the movement.

ECOSYSTEM PARTNERS

MyGov Platform Partner

Summer Art of Living Community
Partner

Aló Ecosystem Partner

EBM Ecosystem Partner

Zelar Ecosystem Partner

THE MISSION

One Movement. Every Student.

Making cyber safety a cultural reflex, not an afterthought.

Hashtag Suraksha is not a one-time campaign. It is a living ecosystem — five verticals working together, each reinforcing the other, all converging on a single outcome: an India where every young person knows how to stay safe online.

From the AI tutor in the classroom to the national competition stage, from the podcast that makes cybersecurity feel real to the slang lexicon that meets young people where they are — every part of this ecosystem has been designed with one principle in mind: **safety that actually sticks.**

CERT-In × Cyber Buddha × Summer Art of Living × USI × MyGov

India's National Cybersecurity Movement.

#Suraksha

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